Vinicius Okada da Silva

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Citizenship: United States and Brazil

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

University of Tampa August 2025 – Present
Visiting Assistant Professor

EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign *2019 – 2025*
Ph.D. in Economics
Case Western Reserve University *2015 – 2019*
BA Economics, BS Math and Physics

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Applied Microeconomics, Economic History, Development Economics

RESEARCH

Job Market Paper:

"Land Grants in Colonial Brazil: Long-Term Effects on Inequality and Development"

Other Working Papers:

"Jesuit Missionaries in the Colonial Amazon: Long-term Effects on Human Capital" **(Reject and Resubmit at the Journal of Economic Growth)**

"Long-Lasting Effects of Bible Translations on Literacy: Evidence from Sub-Saharan Africa" *with Noelia Romero, Abigail Stocker, and Rebecca Thornton*

"Adapting to Agricultural Crises: Coping Strategies and Environmental Trade-offs" *with Protensia Hadunka* **(Submitted)**

Work in Progress:

"Surnames and Intergenerational Land Concentration: Evidence from Colonial Land Grants in Brazil"

"Marriage Timing & Domestic Violence" *with Abigail Stocker and Joshua Shea*

Book Chapters:

"Jesuits in the Amazon - Colonial Legacies on Education"
Upcoming in *Roots of Underdevelopment: A New Economic and Political History of Latin America and the Caribbean*

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Department of Economics - University of Tampa

Instructor *Fall 2025 – Spring 2026*
ECO 204 - Principles of Microeconomics
Primary instructor for three sections of Principles of Microeconomics (ECO 204), totaling 105 students. Responsible for designing and teaching the course, including lecture materials, homework, and quizzes. The course primarily serves first-year non-economics majors in the College of Business.

Department of Economics - University of Illinois

Instructor *Fall 2022 – Spring 2023*

ECON 303 - Intermediate Macroeconomics

Taught a 200-student course. Led one-third of lectures and three discussion sections while maintaining Head TA duties. Designed new lecture slides, syllabus, homework sets, and exams.

Head Teaching Assistant *Fall 2021 – Spring 2022; Fall 2023 – Spring 2025*

ECON 303 - Intermediate Macroeconomics

Taught a weekly section of 50 minutes each for 60-90 students. Responsible for coordinating with other Teaching Assistants on the content to be presented at each section. Also responsible for grading and creating the rubric for each exam.

Teaching Assistant *Fall 2020 – Spring 2021*

ECON 303 - Intermediate Macroeconomics

Taught weekly sections of 50 minutes each for 60-90 students. Responsible for creating slides for each section. Taught primarily on Zoom.

List of Teachers Ranked as Excellent (7 out of 10 semesters):

Fall 2020, Fall 2021, Spring 2022, Fall 2022, Spring 2024, Fall 2024, Spring 2025

Case Western Reserve University

Supplemental Instructor *Fall 2018 – Spring 2019*

PHYS 121 – General Physics I: Mechanics

Teaching Assistant *Spring 2019*

ECON 327 – Advanced Econometrics

AWARDS

University of Illinois Lemann Fellowship *Summer 2023*

University of Illinois Conference Travel Award *Fall 2023*

University of Illinois Graduate Fellowship *Fall 2019, Spring 2020*

PRESENTATIONS

2025: Seton Hall University; Midwest International Economic Development Conference

2024: Northeast Universities Development Consortium Conference; University of Illinois, Agricultural & Consumer Economics Department IPAD Seminar; University of Illinois, Economics Department - Applied Micro Seminars (2x)

2023: Association for the Study of Religion, Economics, and Culture Conference; Southern Economic Association; Comparative & International Education Society Conference; University of Illinois, Economics Department - Applied Micro Seminars (2x)

2022: University of Illinois, Economics Department - Applied Micro Seminars (2x)

2021: Development Day at Notre Dame

LANGUAGES

Portuguese (Native), **English** (Fluent), **French** (Intermediate)

REFEREE SERVICES

Economics of Education Review , *The Quarterly Journal of Economics*

REFERENCES

Rebecca Thornton
Professor
Department of Economics
University of Notre Dame
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Felipe Valencia Caicedo
Assistant Professor
Department of Economics
Brown University
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Consumer Economics
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